

Sedigheh Monavari

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EDUCATION

Warwick Business School, University of Warwick Ph.D., Marketing (Candidate)	2024 – 2027 (Expected)
Warwick Business School, University of Warwick M.Res., Business and Management (Marketing focus)	2024
Amirkabir University of Technology MSc, Business Administration (GPA: 18.3/20)	2021
Sharif University of Technology BSc, Computer Software Engineering (GPA: 16.3/20)	2016

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Topics: Pricing & Promotions, Promotional Timing, Digital Platforms, Consumer Health.

Methods: Econometrics, Causal Inference, Machine Learning, Meta-Analysis, LLM Synthetic Simulations.

SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

“Planned vs. Impulse: Discount Format” (with Iman Ahmadi, Nick Lee, and John Rudd) — *Job Market Paper*.

Abstract: In this paper, we look into the causal mechanisms differentiating pre-announced, platform-wide discounts from immediate, decision-point offers. Utilizing a 17-month panel ($N \approx 45k$) and a doubly robust PSM-TWFE design, we find that immediate discounts generate three times the net revenue response per month and drive substantial revenue gains across all customer value tiers, whereas planned discounts fail to increase net spend among low-value consumers due to budgetary absorption.

“Beyond Single LLMs: Using Model Ensembles to Improve Synthetic Data in Marketing Experiments” (with Mohammad Sheikhan, Marco Gregori, and Iman Ahmadi) — *Submitted to the International Journal of Research in Marketing*.

Short Abstract: We develop a multi-step framework for improving LLM-human alignment through multi-model ensembling, covariate-based recalibration, and response-style adjustment, generating synthetic responses from four LLM families (ChatGPT, Gemini, DeepSeek, Grok) across six published marketing experiments and integrating them with human samples via Recalibrated Prediction-Powered Inference (RePPI). The full pipeline improves LLM-human correlations from $r \approx 0.08$ for the best single model to $r \approx 0.40$, with response-style recalibration contributing the dominant gains, and reduces standard errors by approximately 16% on average, corresponding to an effective labeled-sample-size increase of roughly 24% (up to 44–52% in the strongest cases). These findings demonstrate that current-generation LLMs can generate real inferential leverage when treated not as substitutes for human participants, but as recalibrated surrogates that make limited human data go further.

“Decomposing Promotional Timing: When Discounts Are Given, When Rewards Arrive, and Why the Difference Matters” — *Working Paper*.

Abstract: This research conducts a meta-analysis of effect sizes from academic papers (2017–2026) to decompose promotional timing into signaling (immediate vs. planned) and reward delivery (instant vs. delayed)[cite: 158]. Results indicate that reward timing is the primary driver of effectiveness, where instant rewards significantly outperform delayed ones. However, the disadvantage of delayed rewards is almost entirely offset when consumers receive advance notice (planned signaling), allowing for anticipatory mental accounting.

OTHER RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

“Consumer Expectations and Monetisation on a Digital Health Platform” (with Iman Ahmadi, Nick Lee, and John Rudd)

Short Abstract: Examines how the type of monetisation strategy adopted by a publicly oriented digital health platform shapes user engagement, satisfaction, and trust. Contrasting complementary partnerships (augmenting existing NHS functions) with substitutable premium services (paid alternatives to free-at-point-of-use care), we apply difference-in-differences and dynamic topic modelling to user session data and app-store reviews from the MyGP platform (UK NHS, iPLATO).

“Polling with AI: Can LLM Surrogates Supplement Probabilistic Sampling for Voting-Intention Research?” (with Mohammad Sheikhian Kazerooni, Marco Gregori, and Iman Ahmadi)

Short Abstract: We evaluate whether large language model predictions can supplement a small human survey sample to produce statistically valid and more precise constituency-level estimates of voting intention ahead of the 2026 Scottish Parliament election. We recruited approximately 1,200 Scottish residents via Prolific and generate large-scale synthetic predictions from four LLMs (GPT-4, Gemini, DeepSeek, Grok) conditioned on synthetic demographic profiles drawn from Scottish census data, with no human participant data entered into any AI system at any stage. These AI-generated predictions are combined with observed human responses using Prediction-Powered Inference (PPI, PPI+, RePPI) and a hierarchical extension, producing valid confidence intervals even when surrogate predictions are imperfect or partially biased.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS AND TALKS

“Beyond Single LLMs: Using Model Ensembles to Improve Synthetic Data in Marketing Experiments” — 2026, **INFORMS Marketing Science (ISMS)**, Oral Presentation (Upcoming).

“Beyond the Bargain: Deciphering the Complexities of Food Choices” — 2023, **European Marketing Academy (EMAC)**, Poster.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Marketing and Strategy Analytics — Graduate Teaching Assistant **2024, 2025**
MSc, Warwick Business School

Managerial Decision Making — Graduate Teaching Assistant **2020 – 2021**
MBA, Amirkabir University of Technology

REFERENCES

Prof. Iman Ahmadi (Advisor)

Associate Professor of Marketing, Warwick Business School | iman.ahmadi@wbs.ac.uk

Prof. Nick Lee(Advisor)

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